CLIENT BRIEF
Prepared for: Sreerupa Chakraborty, Strategy Consultant
From: Meher Anand, Founder — Kavaan
Re: Manufacturing & Production Strategy — Urgent Input Needed

ABOUT ME & KAVAAN

Hi, I'm Meher. I started Kavaan about 14 months ago after five years in fashion merchandising for a mid-size retail chain in Ahmedabad. I kept seeing the same gap in the market — plus-size women (Indian sizing L–5XL) wanting ethnic-fusion pieces that actually fit well and don't look like an afterthought "extended size" version of a smaller design. Most fusion-wear brands treat plus-size as a percentage markup on a base pattern, not a design decision in its own right. That's the whole reason Kavaan exists.

Brand positioning: "Fusion wear, cut right the first time." We do Indo-western silhouettes — think structured kurta jackets, dhoti-pant co-ord sets, asymmetric cape dupattas over fitted blouses — built on size-inclusive patterns from day one, not graded-up basics.

Where we are right now:
- 1 core collection designed (18 SKUs across 4 silhouette families)
- Samples completed with our development manufacturer (small atelier in Ahmedabad, does beautiful sample work but charges premium per-piece rates)
- Instagram following: ~9,200, mostly warm audience from my merchandising-industry contacts, some organic reach
- Zero bulk production yet — this is where I need your help
- Bootstrapped, no external funding. I have roughly ₹6 lakh set aside for this first production run — that's it.

THE PROBLEM (IN MY OWN WORDS)

Here's where I'm stuck, and honestly a bit anxious about.

My sample manufacturer, let's call them ***Atelier A***, made all 18 SKUs beautifully. But their bulk pricing is nearly double what I've been quoted by a larger factory in Tiruppur — let's call them ***Factory B***. Factory B can do the volume I need at a price that actually lets me make margin. Obvious move, right? Switch to Factory B for the bulk run.

But when I approached Factory B with my tech packs and samples from Atelier A, they told me they'd need to ***redo the patterns and re-approve fit from scratch*** — because they didn't develop the block patterns themselves, and my sizing runs are non-standard (we grade differently for plus-size fit, not just linear scaling). Their estimate: 6-8 weeks of re-development, plus a "sampling fee" that's eating into the savings I thought I was getting.

On top of that:
- Factory B's ***MOQ is 300 pieces per style***. Across 18 SKUs, that's 5,400 pieces minimum — which is way more than my ₹6 lakh budget and way more than I'm confident I can sell before styles go stale.

- I hadn't actually budgeted for the fact that ***some percentage of this stock won't sell at full price*** — I priced everything assuming near-full-price sell-through, and I'm now realizing that's probably unrealistic.
- I also don't have a clear sense of ***how fast I actually need to be selling through stock*** to stay healthy — I've just been assuming "as fast as possible," which isn't a real plan.

What I need from you: A sourcing and production strategy that gets me into bulk production without falling into this restart trap, that fits my actual cash position, and a realistic pricing/markdown plan so I'm not caught off guard six months from now. I don't want a generic "here's how manufacturing works" answer — I want something built around my actual numbers and constraints.

GARMENT CRITERIA (FOR VISUAL/SAMPLE REFERENCE)

Use these as generation prompts or mood-board criteria for realistic product visuals:

Silhouette Family 1 — Structured Kurta Jackets
- Open-front, collarless jacket-style kurta, mid-thigh to knee length
- Worn over a fitted inner camisole or blouse
- Fabric: raw silk or silk-cotton blend, structured (not flowy)
- Detailing: minimal contrast piping along the front placket, no heavy embroidery (keeps cost per piece down)
- Size range: L to 5XL, cut with side-panel darting for waist definition rather than simple width-grading

Silhouette Family 2 — Dhoti-Pant Co-ord Sets
- Cropped straight-cut kurta top (waist to hip length) paired with draped dhoti-style pants
- Fabric: cotton-linen blend for the top, slightly heavier cotton-silk for the dhoti drape to hold shape
- Color-blocked top and bottom (two-tone within the same palette family)
- Size range: L to 5XL, dhoti pants with adjustable waist tie (not elastic-only) for fit consistency across sizes

Silhouette Family 3 — Cape-Dupatta Fusion Sets
- Fitted, structured blouse (boat neck or high neck) with an asymmetric cape-style dupatta draped over one shoulder, pinned at the waist
- Fabric: blouse in stretch-silk blend (for fit precision on plus sizes), cape in lightweight chanderi or organza
- Detailing: subtle gota-patti edge on the cape hem only — no embellishment on the fitted blouse
- Size range: L to 5XL

Silhouette Family 4 — Fusion Wrap Dresses
- Ankle-length wrap-style dress with an angrakha-inspired asymmetric closure
- Fabric: modal-silk blend
- Solid base color with a contrast border print at the hem
- Size range: L to 5XL, wrap-tie construction for adjustable fit rather than fixed-seam sizing